



June 19, 2025

DFHV Director Rogers

Dear Director Rogers,

As Chair of the Multimodal Accessibility Advisory Council (MAAC), I write to follow up regarding the ongoing concerns about wheelchair accessible vehicle (WAV) service in the District of Columbia following your presentation and discussion at the March MAAC meeting. We are seeking updates on the critical accessibility issues that were discussed and require your continued attention to ensure equitable transportation access for all District residents.

The MAAC, established under D.C. Law 21-124, the "Transportation Reorganization Amendment Act of 2016," codified in D.C. Official Code § 50-2361.31, is vested with the legal authority to "serve as the advisory body to the Mayor, the Council, and District agencies on making local transit and public space in the District more accessible to persons with disabilities." It is in this capacity that we bring this important follow-up matter to your attention.

We remain deeply concerned about the inequitable WAV cab service in DC and are interested in any updates on efforts to address these disparities. During the March meeting, we discussed several critical metrics that would help assess the current state of accessibility in taxi services.

We are specifically seeking updates on the comparison metrics that were discussed during the March meeting, including wait time from order to service received for WAV customers versus non-WAV customers, as well as orders fulfilled versus unfulfilled for WAV customers compared to non-WAV customers. These metrics are essential for understanding the scope of the accessibility gap and measuring progress toward equitable service.

Additionally, we require updates on the number of WAVs operating non-TDC trips and any changes to the pilot program, including results of those efforts. The effectiveness of these programs directly impacts the availability of accessible transportation options for District residents with mobility disabilities.

We also need resolution on the concerning issue involving MAAC member Naomi Hess's complaint regarding failure to receive WAV service. Were you able to investigate the improper dismissal of her complaint? Can you provide detailed information on what happened and confirm whether DFHV has re-opened the investigation into this matter? This case represents broader systemic issues that require immediate attention.

Furthermore, we are interested in any progress made on establishing a secret shopper program for WAV service, which would provide valuable data on service quality and accessibility compliance across the taxi fleet.

Following our March discussion, MAAC requests specific updates on the following critical areas:

MAAC requests that DFHV provide comprehensive updates on the following initiatives by July 31, 2025:

- Wait time comparison data for WAV versus non-WAV customers
- Fulfillment rate comparison data for WAV versus non-WAV service requests
- Current number of WAVs operating non-TDC trips and pilot program results
- Status and resolution of Naomi Hess's service complaint investigation
- Progress report on secret shopper program implementation
- Any additional measures implemented to improve WAV service equity

These updates are essential for MAAC to fulfill our advisory role and ensure that the District is making measurable progress toward accessible and equitable transportation for all residents, particularly those with mobility disabilities.

We would like to invite you back to present these updates to the MAAC at our October meeting on Wednesday, October 8, 2025, at 5:30 PM. If this date does not work with your schedule, please let us know and we can explore alternative meeting dates to ensure your participation.

MAAC stands ready to collaborate with DFHV to ensure the success of these accessibility initiatives. Our expertise and perspective can be valuable in identifying barriers, developing solutions, and ensuring that accessibility improvements meet the real-world needs of District residents with disabilities.

We appreciate your prompt attention to this important accessibility matter. The residents of our city deserve nothing less than our utmost effort to ensure equitable access to transportation services for all community members, regardless of disability status.

Sincerely,
Dr. Karthik Balasubramanian
Chair, Multimodal Accessibility Advisory Council

CC:

- MAAC Members
- Naomi Hess, MAAC Member
- Kelly Mack, MAAC
- Elizabeth Ragan, MAAC
- Sal, MAAC
- Lizzy, MAAC